Malta's environmental taxes

The Commission's 2026 Country Report, checked against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

"Total environmental tax revenue is lower than the EU average (1.4% of GDP in 2024 against 2.1%)."

European Commission, 2026 Country Report – Malta, 3 June 2026

Annex 10 (circular economy), with Annex 3 on taxation.

The report also gives energy and transport shares for 2023 and pollution taxes of 0.18% of GDP.

VERDICT

LARGELY SUPPORTED

Figures exact; one number is from the year before.

SUPPORTED | **LARGELY SUPPORTED** | NOT SUBSTANTIATED | MISLEADING | CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

1.35%

Malta, 2024

Environmental taxes as a share of GDP: EUR 312.5 million on GDP of EUR 23,079 million.

2.08%

EU-27, 2024

The Commission rounds to 1.4% and 2.1%. The gap is 0.73 points of GDP.

25th

Of 27 states

Only Ireland (0.98%) and Luxembourg (1.18%) are lower. Malta was 2.38% in 2019.

49 / 41

Energy / transport

2023 shares: 48.5% and 41.6%. Together 90% of the total.

0.15%

Pollution taxes, 2023

The report says 0.18%, which is Eurostat's 2022 value. Still above the EU's 0.08%.

FAIR TO SAY

This tests the figures, not whether Malta should tax more. Revenue as a share of GDP is not a measure of policy strictness.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

- ☐ Commission: the data vintage behind the 0.18%.
- ☐ Finance Ministry: revenue by tax behind the three categories.
- ☐ Eurostat: any revision of Malta's 2024 values.
- ☐ No right of reply needed.